When thinking from Freed's single shot, one can sense how proximity and distance, intimacy and anonymity, play out with Freed's early depictions of the Wall. Given the middle distance established within the image, Freed reinforces the space separating him from his subjects and weighs the legacy of segregation more broadly. Though formality in portraiture can suggest cooperation between a subject and a photographer, here it is evidence of their strained relation and invites speculation on the curious stance of the soldier in this image. The parallel trolley tracks assume both photographer and subject are standing in a shared urban environment, though the soldier's motion toward the gun on his hip portends the possibility of friction. Freed's central framing of the soldier at a middle distance also pushes his viewers to think about what other social buffers he intends us to envision in this image. The two men are depicted as isolated from one another, though they stand in for a broader shared mapping of segregated social relations. Whether Freed invites viewers to focus on the space between the soldier and the Wall behind him or between the soldier and his distracted comrades, the converging perspectives lend this image a sense of multiple associative disconnects, underwritten by the geopolitical weight of the exchange. The downward gaze of the soldier and his hand positioned by his holster also suggest a deliberate distancing from Freed or at least emphasize the tense nature of the encounter. The prospect of mutual recognition in the American sector of West Berlin also suggests other borders beyond the Wall.